Ship Thesis: Blog Automation Spec

Draft v1 · November 2, 2026 · Written to be handed to Antigravity

1. What this system does

One command researches what US founders are asking right now, writes the keyword.doc, drafts pages from a fixed template, makes matching cover images, checks everything against Ship Thesis rules, and queues posts for review. The goal is to be found in Google, Bing, ChatGPT, Claude, Perplexity and Gemini and to win the first US client.

No one can guarantee a ranking or a citation. So every page carries a visibility sheet that measures what actually happens, and the system adjusts from the results.

Terms used in this document

- **Blog:** a founder-decision page that answers one question.
- **Block:** a technical blueprint page (architecture diagram, schema, implementation).
- **SEO:** search engines (Google, Bing).
- **AEO:** answer engines (featured answers, zero-click answers).
- **GEO:** generative engines (AI assistants that write answers and cite sources).

2. Hard rules (Antigravity must enforce all of them)

- No pricing, price ranges, cost, budget or hourly-rate content anywhere. Topics with price intent are rejected at research time.
- Timelines are written only as "in weeks." No week numbers or ranges.
- The 3:4:3 payment split is allowed (it is a percentage structure, not a price) and applies to every project.
- No team members are named anywhere. Content is attributed to "Ship Thesis."
- Do not claim or imply US client work. There are no US clients yet.
- Do not name client companies without written permission.
- Voice: plain, direct, first-person plural ("we"). No hype words.
- Graphics: light/white theme.
- Every claim about Ship Thesis must come from the claims ledger (section 4). If a needed claim is missing, stop and ask.

- Never invent trends, statistics, quotes or sources. Every topic and every number needs a source URL and a date, or it is marked unverified and excluded.

3. Pipeline and commands

Command	What it does	Output
`blog:research`	Finds trending founder questions, scores them, builds the keyword.doc	`keyword.doc` (.docx plus .md mirror)
`blog:brief <slug>`	Pulls what currently ranks and gets cited, finds the gap, assigns a ledger claim	`/briefs/<slug>.md`
`blog:draft <slug>`	Writes the page from the template	`/content/blog/<slug>.mdx` or `/content/blocks/<slug>.mdx`
`blog:image <slug>`	Renders the cover and social images from the one image template	`/public/covers/<slug>-*.png`
`blog:lint <slug>`	Runs every rule in section 10	Pass/fail report
`blog:review`	Lists drafts waiting for human review	Review queue
`blog:publish <slug>`	Builds, adds schema, updates sitemap, pings IndexNow, queues a LinkedIn post draft	Live page
`blog:track`	Runs the prompt bank across assistants and updates visibility sheets	`visibility-report.md`

Status flow for every page: researched → briefed → drafted → lint pass → reviewed → scheduled → live → tracked.

4. Claims ledger (starter, Adiya to confirm before first use)

The generator may state facts about Ship Thesis only from this list.

- Ship Thesis builds MVPs for founders: web, mobile apps and SaaS.
- Payment split is 3:4:3 on every project.
- The founder gets a working build to test on their own phone every week (Friday builds).
- Code lives in the client's own GitHub from day one.
- Offer: a 1-week Discovery Sprint.
- Offer: a free 20-minute assessment call.
- Stack: Next.js, Supabase/PostgreSQL, Flutter, TypeScript.
- Proof: AssessYourself, an exam-prep platform for 10,000+ students.
- Rule of thumb we use: a first MVP is cut down to about three screens.
- Reviews and testimonials: to be added after they go live on the site (in a few days).

Not allowed: prices, week counts, team names, client names without permission, US client claims.

5. Research: finding trending topics

Sources (record URL and date for every item used)

- Reddit: r/startups, r/SaaS, r/Entrepreneur, r/indiehackers, r/FlutterDev, r/nextjs, r/supabase (read through search or the official API, within terms of service).
- Hacker News, Indie Hackers, founder newsletters, YC content.
- Google Trends (US), Google People Also Ask and autocomplete, Bing related searches.
- GitHub issues and Stack Overflow for technical Block topics.
- Live prompt tests: ask ChatGPT, Claude, Perplexity and Gemini the way a US founder would, and record which sources they cite.
- Product Hunt discussions may be read for topic ideas only. It is not a distribution channel.

Method

1. Collect candidate questions from the last 30 days.

2. Merge duplicates into one exact target prompt per topic, phrased the way a founder would type it.
3. Auto-reject price-intent topics, job-seeker topics, consumer-app topics, and topics where Ship Thesis has no ledger claim and no real experience.
4. Score the rest out of 100.

Scoring

Factor	Points	What it measures
US founder intent	25	Is the asker a founder who might hire an MVP builder?
Demand and trend	20	Activity in the last 30 days, repeated across at least two sources
Winnability	20	Existing answers are thin, outdated or generic
Claim fit	20	A verified ledger claim or a real project detail fits the topic
Timeliness	15	Tied to something current (a tool change, a launch, a common new question)

Score 70 or more: queue. 60 to 69: hold for next run. Below 60: reject, with the reason logged.

6. keyword.doc format

The research command produces this document on every run. It is a Word-compatible file with a Markdown copy.

Part A: Ranked topics

#	Topic	Exact target prompt	Page type	Score	Sources (URL, date)	Ledger claim used	Slug

Part B: Visibility sheet per topic (filled at brief time, updated by `blog:track`)

Field	Content
Target prompts	3 to 5 prompts this page should win
SEO check	Score from section 7
AEO check	Score from section 7
GEO check	Score from section 7
Assistants check	Score from section 7
Baseline	For ChatGPT, Claude, Perplexity and Gemini: is Ship Thesis mentioned (yes/no) and who is cited instead
Re-test dates	7, 14 and 30 days after publishing, with results

Part C: Publishing schedule. The queue for the next 14 days, with date, slug and status.

Part D: Rejected topics. Topic, score and reason (for example "price intent").

Part E: Run log. Date, sources reached, sources that failed, topics found, topics queued.

7. Optimization layers and scorecard

Each layer has five checks worth 5 points each, for 25 points per layer and 100 in total. A page needs 85 or more, and no layer below 18, to be published.

SEO (search engines)

1. Title 60 characters or fewer with the main phrase, meta description 140 to 160 characters, one H1, a clean slug.
2. Indexable: canonical tag, in the sitemap, returns 200, no noindex. Submitted to Google Search Console and Bing, plus an IndexNow ping.
3. At least 3 internal links to related pages and 3 links from them back, plus breadcrumbs.
4. Valid JSON-LD (Article, Organization, BreadcrumbList, and FAQPage when the page has an FAQ), Open Graph tags, image alt text.
5. Static HTML, fast and stable on mobile (Core Web Vitals pass).

AEO (answer engines)

1. The H1 is the question, or a plain-language claim.
2. A direct answer in the first two sentences, roughly 40 to 60 words, that makes sense on its own if quoted.
3. An FAQ with 3 to 5 real follow-up questions, each answered in one to three sentences.
4. At least one list, table or step sequence.
5. Key terms defined in one line on first use.

GEO (generative engines)

1. At least one claim only Ship Thesis can make, taken from the ledger.
2. One real detail from a project: a decision, a trade-off, a bug or a screen.
3. Every number or factual claim has a source, or is labeled as our own experience.
4. The company is named "Ship Thesis" consistently, with the same one-line description everywhere.
5. An off-site plan for the page's idea: where it will also be mentioned (a LinkedIn post, a directory listing, a community answer, a review snippet). Mentions on other sites matter for recommendation-style prompts.

Assistants (ChatGPT, Claude, Perplexity, Gemini)

1. robots.txt allows the search and user-fetch bots of each assistant. Check each vendor's current documentation for bot names (for example OAI-SearchBot, ChatGPT-User, PerplexityBot, Claude's search and user bots, Googlebot, Bingbot). Allowing or blocking training bots is a separate policy choice.
2. The full content is readable without JavaScript (verify with a plain `curl`).
3. The page is indexed in Bing as well as Google. This is a cheap hedge, because several assistants lean on web search.
4. Before publishing, 3 to 5 target prompts are run across the assistants and logged as the baseline.
5. Referral tracking is on: GA4 sources for chatgpt.com, perplexity.ai, claude.ai and similar, plus UTM tags on links we place elsewhere.

What we cannot control. Which sources an assistant picks changes by model, by day and by how the question is phrased. The scorecard raises the odds. The tracking tells us whether it worked.

8. Page templates

Blog template (900 to 1,400 words, never padded)

1. H1 as the question.
2. Answer box: the two-sentence direct answer.
3. Short version: three bullets.
4. Body: three to five H2 sections phrased as sub-questions, with one table or checklist.
5. "How Ship Thesis does it": ledger claims only, plus the real project detail.
6. FAQ: three to five questions.
7. CTA: the free 20-minute assessment call or the 1-week Discovery Sprint. No prices.
8. Footer: last-updated date, author shown as "Ship Thesis."

Block template

1. The problem in one sentence, then the answer.
2. Architecture diagram (Mermaid).
3. Schema or types.
4. Implementation steps with code that has been run and tested.
5. Failure modes and edge cases.
6. When to use it and when not to.
7. CTA: "Need this built into your MVP?" with the free assessment call.

9. Image template (one template, reused everywhere)

Sizes: 1200×630 (blog cover and Open Graph), plus a LinkedIn variant (1200×627 or 1080×1080). Same template, resized grid.

Layout (three zones):

- Top-left: a small category chip (MVP, SaaS, Mobile, BLOCK).
- Left and center: the headline, at most 8 words over 2 to 3 lines, large.
- Right: one simple vector illustration or mini-diagram built from basic shapes.
- Bottom: Ship Thesis wordmark on the left, shipthesis.com on the right.

Style: light/white background, one accent color, dark text, generous spacing. The exact accent color, typeface and illustration style are decided after Adiya's reference images are reviewed.

Rules: no stock photos, no faces, no prices, no client logos without permission, no small text.

Blocks use the same template. Only the chip changes to BLOCK, and the illustration area shows a mini architecture diagram.

How to build it: an HTML/SVG template with variables (`headline` , `category` , `illustration_id`), rendered to PNG with a script (for example Playwright). This keeps text sharp and consistent. AI image generators tend to garble text, so use them, if at all, only for background elements.

Reference images: used only to extract layout, spacing, type mood and color feel. Write a short inspiration-notes file describing what is taken. Never copy a composition, logo or illustration.

Approval step: generate three sample covers in the template, Adiya picks one, then freeze it as `template-v1` . After that, every blog and block uses it.

10. Quality gates (`blog:lint`)

Blocking (page cannot ship):

- Any `$` , "USD", "price", "cost", "budget", "cheap" or "per hour" in the page.
- Any numeric timeline, such as "6 weeks" or "4 to 8 weeks."
- Any team member name.
- A claim about Ship Thesis that is not in the ledger.
- A statistic without a source and date.
- The direct answer is not in the first two sentences.
- Missing or invalid schema, broken links, or an image without alt text.
- Duplicate title or slug.
- Hype phrases (for example "game-changing," "cutting-edge," "in today's fast-paced world").
- Block pages: code that does not compile or run.

Warnings: over 1,600 words, no list or table, average sentence over 22 words.

11. Human review (5 to 10 minutes per page)

1. Every statement about Ship Thesis is true.
2. Add or confirm one real project detail.
3. Read the first two sentences. They should be worth quoting.
4. Check the CTA and the cover image.
5. Approve, or send back with a note.

12. Posting cadence (the "how many a day" setting)

The default is deliberately conservative. Quality and review time are the limit, not the tool.

```
{
  "blog":  { "max_per_day": 1, "days": ["Mon", "Wed", "Fri"] },
  "block": { "max_per_week": 2 },
  "global_cap_per_day": 2,
  "min_score": 70,
  "max_review_queue": 3,
  "never_fill_quota_with_weak_topics": true
}
```

Ramp:

- Weeks 1 and 2: 3 blogs per week.
- Weeks 3 and 4: up to 4 blogs and 1 block per week.
- From week 5: up to 1 blog per weekday and 2 blocks per week, only while the review queue stays at 3 or fewer and enough topics score 70 or more.

If fewer topics pass the threshold, publish fewer. Never publish to hit a number.

13. Tracking and refresh

- **Prompt bank** (`prompts.json`): 50 to 100 prompts grouped by intent, each mapped to a page, refreshed monthly.
- **Weekly run** (`blog:track`): run the prompts across ChatGPT, Claude, Perplexity and Gemini, logged out, with search on where available. Record mentioned (yes/no), cited URL, and which competitors appear. API results can differ from the consumer apps, so note which was used.

- **Weekly report** (`visibility-report.md`): pages live, indexed in Google and Bing, prompts where Ship Thesis appears, new citations, referral sessions from assistants, competitors that appear most.
- **Refresh rule:** not cited after 30 days, rewrite the answer box and add outside mentions. Cited, add FAQ answers for the follow-up questions people ask. Refresh the topic list every month.

14. Seed topics (starting ideas, not research)

`blog:research` must replace or extend these with sourced, current topics.

Blogs

- How 3:4:3 milestone payments protect founders on an MVP
- How to make sure you own your code when hiring an MVP agency
- What a weekly working build on your phone looks like
- What to cut from your first MVP (the three-screen rule)
- Flutter vs React Native for an MVP
- Next.js with Supabase for a SaaS MVP
- How to vet a dev studio: red flags before you sign
- What a 1-week Discovery Sprint is and what you get
- What to prepare before you talk to an MVP developer
- AssessYourself case study (after reviews are on the site)

Blocks

- Next.js and Supabase: multi-tenant auth with row-level security
- Stripe subscription webhooks that never miss an event
- Flutter offline sync with SQLite
- Deterministic PDF extraction into a typed schema

15. Build prompt for Antigravity (copy and paste)

> You are building a blog automation pipeline for shipthesis.com (Next.js, static output, content as MDX in the repo). Read the whole spec first.
>
> Create: `/content/claims-ledger.md`, `/config/blog.config.json` (section 12), `/config/lint-rules.json` (section 10), `/prompts/prompts.json`, `/templates/blog.mdx`, `/templates/block.mdx`, `/templates/cover/template-v1.html`, and scripts for the commands in section 3.
>
> Rules: never invent trends, statistics or quotes. Every topic needs a source URL and date. If a source cannot be fetched, mark it unverified and exclude it from scoring. Only state facts about Ship Thesis that are in the claims ledger, and stop and ask if one is missing. Enforce every hard rule in section 2.
>
> Work in phases and show me the output after each one:
>
> 1. `blog:research` and the keyword.doc only.
> 2. The image template: three sample covers for approval, using my reference images as inspiration only.
> 3. Drafting, the scorecard and lint.
> 4. Publishing, schema, IndexNow and tracking.

16. Still needed from Adiya

- The reference images (they have not been shared yet).
- Accent color and typeface preferences, or "choose from the references."
- Confirmation of the claims ledger in section 4.
- Confirmation of the `/blog` and `/blocks` routes.
- A decision on whether LinkedIn posts are drafted for manual posting or posted automatically.
- The date the reviews go live on the site.